

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 08/30/2024 08:32:36 AM
To: McCurdy, Christopher R
Subject: Congressional Invite for Kratom Briefing on Sept. 20

[External Email]

Good Morning Dr. McCurdy,

We are working with members of congress to send you an invitation to present at the Kratom Science Congressional Briefing on September 20. Could you please provide me with the address and email that the letter of invitation should be sent to?

Best Regards,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: McCurdy,Christopher R
Sent time: 08/30/2024 08:59:59 AM
To: staylor@americankratom.org
Subject: Re: Congressional Invite for Kratom Briefing on Sept. 20

Please use the following:

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
The Frank A. Duckworth Eminent Scholar Chair
Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
Department of Medicinal Chemistry
College of Pharmacy
University of Florida
HPNP 4322
1225 Center Drive
Gainesville, FL 32610
Office: (352) 294-8691
Email: cmccurdy@ufl.edu

Also, please copy our government relations VP, Mark Kaplan - mark.kaplan@ufl.edu

From: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>
Sent: Friday, August 30, 2024 8:32 AM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Subject: Congressional Invite for Kratom Briefing on Sept. 20

[External Email]

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From: The American Kratom Association <Advocacy@americankratom.org>
Sent time: 08/30/2024 12:46:20 PM
To: McCurdy, Christopher R
Subject: Recap

[External Email]

K e e p K r a t o m S a f e



August Advocacy Recap & Local ban meetings

Summer flew by for the AKA team and no month was busier than this one. In August alone we had a number of incredibly important developments including:

- [The FDA withdrew their seriously flawed proposed study of kratom](#)
- [California shelved their convoluted and contentious kratom regulation bill that the AKA does not support](#)
- [The AKA legislative team and amazing advocates presented to the National Conference of State Legislators on the need to protect American's right to safe kratom and the dangers of criminalizing American kratom consumers](#)
- The AKA and industry delegation met with Indonesian officials to continue dialogue on their work on product safety and many important and pressing issues.

Now as we look to September we're working against local bans in **Iowa City** ([click here](#)), **Needham Massachusetts** ([click here](#)), and we're closing tracking developments of previously proposed bans in New Jersey and North Carolina as state legislatures return to session.

This fall we'll be busy working across America; especially to reverse bans in all six banned states (with key events coming in Arkansas, Indiana and Wisconsin.)

Stay tuned for more details and [subscribe to our YouTube channel for the latest video announcements](#).

Also, we need all Veterans and Law Enforcement kratom advocates to connect with us to help on special projects to educate officials and combat many misconceptions about kratom consumers.

[Go to the ProtectKratom.org Veterans page today!](#)

Do you know why August is the most historic month in American Kratom History?

On August 16th, 2018, the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) made a momentous decision by rescinding its recommendation to the Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA) to classify kratom as a Schedule I substance. This critical decision was communicated in a letter by Assistant Secretary for Health, ADM Brett Giroir, to the DEA – [a letter that has become a cornerstone of our ongoing fight to protect kratom.](#)

As we commemorate this anniversary, we are reminded that our work is far from over. The threat of kratom being unjustly restricted remains.

Victories have been because of your donations of dollars and time and to [keep winning we need your support.](#)

[Please consider making a donation today to help us continue the fight](#)

Thank you for your unwavering support. Every contribution makes a difference!

[Donate \\$20.00 today!](#)

[Donate to Help Continue the Fight](#)

[Use PayPal to Donate](#)



CITY OF IOWA CITY COUNCIL ACTION REPORT

Item Number: 3.a.

September 3, 2024

Work Session Minutes: August 20

Attachments: [Work Session Minutes: August 20](#)

6. **Tobacco Moratorium discussion [continued from August 6]**

City Attorney Goers guided Councilors through the identified issues provided in the memo (IP3 Memo from City Attorney: Tobacco permit ordinance amendment questions) which was included in the August 15 Information Packet. Councilors considered the option of a permit cap, zoning options which included a 500' separation distance between applicants and both other retailers and school property, a suggested 60-day grandfather rights retention period, and the option to ban outright or regulate the sale of Kratom. Individual Council members asked questions and expressed their views. City Manager Fruin, City Attorney Goers, City Clerk Grace and Becky Connelly, Community and Family Resources, provided additional information.

Action: Staff will craft an ordinance that creates 500ft distance separation requirements between tobacco retailers and around K-12 and higher education institution properties. The ordinance will include the loss of grandfather rights upon a tobacco use ceasing for 90 days or upon a loss of permit for 60 days. **Simultaneously, actions will be drafted to ban the sale of Kratom** and lift the current tobacco permit moratorium.

Iowa City is pursuing a kratom ban, but they are unlikely to vote on it this Tuesday the 3rd as the ban language isn't on the agenda. Please sign-up on ProtectKratom.org/iowa to make sure you're getting the latest on meetings and events. **All Iowa City residents should contact their representatives immediately and ask them not to support a ban.**



The American Kratom Association applauded the August announcement of the FDA's decision to withdraw its "Proposed Collection; Comment Request: Risk/Safety Considerations and Motivations for Purchase and Use of Kratom and Psychedelics Alone and in Combination with Other Substances" originally published on August 2, 2024.

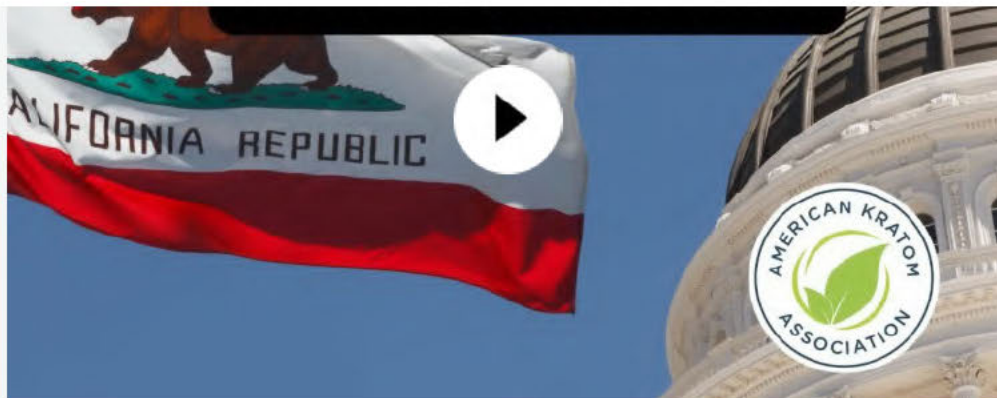
"The FDA has once again shown its clear bias against any harm reduction tool that does not fit into a new drug application model," stated Mac Haddow, Senior Fellow on Public Policy with the AKA. "This is the latest embarrassing mistake driven by a few anti-kratom staff at the FDA, and it is time for Commissioner Califf to exercise direct oversight and order the Agency to reassess its biased attacks on kratom and psychedelics."

The FDA announced its swift withdrawal of the Federal Register Notice that was originally published on August 2, 2024, in a new Notice on August 9 (<https://public-inspection.federalregister.gov/2024-17793.pdf>). The FDA explained that it withdrew the study because "circumstances occurred necessitating changes to the scope of the study."

Please read the full press release below and an immense THANK YOU to all the amazing advocates who were already pushing back on the FDA and supporting the AKA through donations in our work to stop shoddy science like combining a study of kratom with psychedelics.

[Read Release](#)





California's Assembly Bill 2365 to regulate kratom in CA has been shelved for the time being. But what does this mean for Californians and the impact on other states?

Watch for the AKA's perspective and response to these developments.

Last Chance for 2024 HOF Nominations

The AKA is accepting new nominations for Advocacy Hall of Fame Members. All previously nominated members will be reconsidered and we'll make the announcement of new members in late September

[Complete the form here](#)

More News:



AKA's presentation to State Legislators featuring amazing advocate testimonials

Congressional Briefing on kratom

American Kratom Association
13575 Heathcote Blvd.
Ste 320
Gainesville , VA 20155
United States
[unsubscribe](#)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/04/2024 10:51:12 AM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R
Subject: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Good Morning Dr. McCurdy,

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I am also confirming your attendance at the dinner on the evening of the 19th at the Charlie Palmer Steak House at 6:30.

Best Regards,



Stephanie Taylor
Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/04/2024 10:51:47 AM
To: staylor@americankratom.org
Cc: McCurdy, Christopher R
Subject: RE: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

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-----Original Message-----

From: "staylor@americankratom.org" <staylor@americankratom.org>
Sent: Wednesday, September 4, 2024 10:51am
To: "McCurdy, Christopher R" <cmccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Subject: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

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Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

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From: McCurdy,Christopher R
Sent time: 09/04/2024 04:26:41 PM
To: staylor@americankratom.org
Subject: Re: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

Yes, I will attend the dinner and will be at the hotel on the night of the 19th. If it is possible to get an early check-in that would be great as my flight arrives around 11 AM at DCA.

Thank you,
Chris

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
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[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](https://www.americankratom.org/13575-Heathcote-Blvd-#320-Gainesville-VA-20155)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/04/2024 04:41:15 PM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R
Subject: Re: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Good Afternoon Dr. McCurdy,

The hotel cannot guarantee an early check in, but we will request one for you, and they will do their best.

Best,

Stephanie Taylor

-----Original Message-----

From: "McCurdy,Christopher R" <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Sent: Wednesday, September 4, 2024 4:26pm
To: "staylor@americankratom.org" <staylor@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Hotel for Congressional Briefing

Yes, I will attend the dinner and will be at the hotel on the night of the 19th. If it is possible to get an early check-in that would be great as my flight arrives around 11 AM at DCA.

Thank you,

Chris

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
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Stephanie Taylor
Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

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[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/05/2024 10:17:32 AM
To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy,Christopher R
Subject: Early Check-In for 9/19

[External Email]

Good Morning,

You should be receiving a confirmation email soon for your stay at Hyatt Regency on Capitol Hill. I have put in your early check-in requests. I am not sure if your confirmation email will indicate the request, but I wanted to reassure you it has been made. Closer to the 19th, I will follow up with the hotel on the matter. Please let me know if there is anything else I can help you with regarding your stay.

Best,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/05/2024 11:46:34 AM
To: jhenning@pinneyassociates.com; miguet@infionline.net; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy, Christopher R; Boyer, Edward <edward.boyer@osumc.edu>
Cc: Tom Moore <tom@americankratom.org>
Subject: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Good Morning,

We are looking forward to the Congressional Briefing and appreciate your participation in the event. We would like to collect everyone's travel plans and itineraries so we can plan support efforts on our end. Please let me know how you plan on traveling, when you are arriving (date and time), and when you are slated to return.

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<https://www.hyatt.com/hyatt-regency/en-US/wasrw-hyatt-regency-washington-on-capitol-hill>

We have arranged a dinner at the Charlie Palmer Steak House at 6:30pm on Thursday, Sept. 19.

<https://www.charliepalmersteak.com/washington-dc-home/>

Please send travel receipts as soon as possible to our CFO Tom Moore, who is cc'd on this email.

Feel free to reach out with any questions you may have. I am happy to help!

Thank you,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: McCurdy,Christopher R
Sent time: 09/05/2024 12:31:23 PM
To: staylor@americankratom.org; jhenning@pinneyassociates.com; miguet@infionline.net; Boyer, Edward <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>
Cc: Tom Moore <tom@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

Hello,

I arrive on Sept 19th at 11:00 AM to DCA via Delta 0380

I will attend the dinner.

ALSO, I utilized flight credits for the ticket so there is nothing to reimburse. The cost of the ticket was \$837.95 if you need this for your records. I can also provide a receipt to show I utilized eCredit.

Thank you and let me know if you have any questions.
Chris

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Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
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Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
Department of Medicinal Chemistry
College of Pharmacy
University of Florida
HPNP 4322
1225 Center Drive
PO Box 100484
Gainesville, FL 32610
Office: (352) 294-8691

From: Boyer, Edward <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 12:05 PM
To: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; jhenning@pinneyassociates.com <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>; miguet@infionline.net <miguet@infionline.net>
Cc: Tom Moore <tom@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

I arrive AA 4432 at 140pm.

Ed

Edward W Boyer MD PhD (he/him/his)
Professor with Tenure
Ohio State University
Visiting Professor
Harvard Medical School

No trees were killed in the sending of this email; a great number of electrons were, however, terribly inconvenienced.

From: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 11:46 AM
To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy, Christopher R <cmccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Boyer, Edward <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>; jhenning@pinneyassociates.com <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>; miguet@infionline.net <miguet@infionline.net>
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Thank you,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: tom@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/05/2024 01:15:27 PM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Hi Chris,

Thanks for letting me know about the credit. Be sure and keep any receipts while in DC. I look forward to meet you

Tom Moore

-----Original Message-----

From: "McCurdy,Christopher R" <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 12:31pm
To: "Boyer, Edward" <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>, "staylor@americankratom.org" <staylor@americankratom.org>, "Kirsten Smith" <ksmit398@jh.edu>, "jhenning@pinneyassociates.com" <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>, "miguet@infionline.net" <miguet@infionline.net>
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Professor with Tenure

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Visiting Professor

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From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/05/2024 01:46:48 PM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Thank you for your response. What time do you leave on the 20th?

-----Original Message-----

From: "McCurdy,Christopher R" <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 12:31pm
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You will be staying at the Hyatt Regency on Capitol Hill. Check-in is 4pm and check-out is 11am. The hotel will hold luggage for guests through their bell hop service upon check-out if needed. If you need an early check-in, and have not already

communicated it to me, please let me know as soon as possible.

<https://www.hyatt.com/hyatt-regency/en-US/wasrw-hyatt-regency-washington-on-capitol-hill>

We have arranged a dinner at the Charlie Palmer Steak House at 6:30pm on Thursday, Sept. 19.

<https://www.charliepalmersteak.com/washington-dc-home/>

Please send travel receipts as soon as possible to our CFO Tom Moore, who is cc'd on this email.

Feel free to reach out with any questions you may have. I am happy to help!

Thank you,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

[540-300-1605](tel:540-300-1605) | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: McCurdy,Christopher R
Sent time: 09/05/2024 01:52:26 PM
To: staylor@americankratom.org
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

I leave on Friday, the 20th out of DCA on the 1:59 PM Delta 0737 flight to Atlanta. Should have no issues with the timing of the events or stress to get back to DCA!

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
The Frank A. Duckworth Eminent Scholar Chair
Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
Department of Medicinal Chemistry
College of Pharmacy
University of Florida
HPNP 4322
1225 Center Drive
PO Box 100484
Gainesville, FL 32610
Office: (352) 294-8691

From: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 1:46 PM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

Thank you for your response. What time do you leave on the 20th?

-----Original Message-----

From: "McCurdy,Christopher R" <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 12:31pm
To: "Boyer, Edward" <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>, "staylor@americankratom.org" <staylor@americankratom.org>, "Kirsten Smith" <ksmit398@jh.edu>, "jhenning@pinneyassociates.com" <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>, "miguette@infionline.net" <miguette@infionline.net>
Cc: "Tom Moore" <tom@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

Hello,

I arrive on Sept 19th at 11:00 AM to DCA via Delta 0380

I will attend the dinner.

ALSO, I utilized flight credits for the ticket so there is nothing to reimburse. The cost of the ticket was \$837.95 if you need this for your records. I can also provide a receipt to show I utilized eCredit.

Thank you and let me know if you have any questions.

Chris

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
The Frank A. Duckworth Eminent Scholar Chair
Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
Department of Medicinal Chemistry
College of Pharmacy
University of Florida
HPNP 4322
1225 Center Drive
PO Box 100484
Gainesville, FL 32610
Office: (352) 294-8691

From: Boyer, Edward <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>
Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 12:05 PM
To: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; jhenning@pinneyassociates.com <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>; miguette@infionline.net <miguette@infionline.net>
Cc: Tom Moore <tom@americankratom.org>

Subject: Re: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

[External Email]

I arrive AA 4432 at 140pm.

Ed

Edward W Boyer MD PhD (he/him/his)

Professor with Tenure

Ohio State University

Visiting Professor

Harvard Medical School

No trees were killed in the sending of this email; a great number of electrons were, however, terribly inconvenienced.

From: staylor@americankratom.org <staylor@americankratom.org>

Sent: Thursday, September 5, 2024 11:46 AM

To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy, Christopher R <cmcurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Boyer, Edward <Edward.Boyer@osumc.edu>; jhenning@pinneyassociates.com <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>; miguet@infionline.net <miguet@infionline.net>

Cc: Tom Moore <tom@americankratom.org>

Subject: Travel Plans/Itineraries for Congressional Briefing

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Thank you,



Stephanie Taylor

Research and Project Assistant, The American Kratom Association

540-300-1605 | staylor@americankratom.org

[13575 Heathcote Blvd #320 Gainesville VA, 20155](#)

From: staylor@americankratom.org
Sent time: 09/11/2024 05:27:44 PM
To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; Boyer, Edward <edward.boyer@osumc.edu>; McCurdy, Christopher R; Jack Henningfield <jhenning@pinneyassociates.com>
Cc: Mac Haddow <advocacy@americankratom.org>
Subject: Change in Itinerary for the 19th

[External Email]

Good Afternoon,

We are looking forward to the Congressional Briefing and appreciate your participation in this event.

We are changing dinner on the 19th from the Charlie Palmer to the Hyatt Regency on Capitol Hill (where you will all be staying) at 6pm in the Everglades Room.

Below is a rough outline of the itinerary for the 20th.

Sept. 20th

7:30 am: the advocates, scientists, and the AKA will board a sprinter van and be shuttled to the Cannon House Building (or as close as they are allowed). Please prepare for a short walk from the drop off point to the Cannon Bldg.

8:30 Breakfast in Cannon Room 360

9:00 Briefing in Cannon Room 360

11:30 Van transport back to hotel to pick up luggage

Once back at the hotel, those with earlier flights/travel plans will depart for the airport. You will need to arrange your own transport to the airport/home.

For those with a later travel itinerary, we will gather for lunch-at noon, location TBD.

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Best Regards,

Stephanie Taylor

From: The American Kratom Association <Advocacy@americankratom.org>
Sent time: 09/13/2024 11:05:54 AM
To: McCurdy, Christopher R
Subject: We don't scare easily

[External Email]

K e e p K r a t o m S a f e



Alarming Advocacy Updates

Dear Christopher,

It is Friday the 13th and Halloween decorations may already be out in your community, but just this week we saw some seriously scary stuff for kratom advocates.

On Tuesday the House Committee on Energy and Commerce came after kratom hard with Rep. Kathy Castor of Florida pushing the FDA to remove all kratom products and promulgating the Tampa Bay Times stories. Then media outlets like Bloomberg published a slanted scare tactic mini-documentary on kratom that's sure to spur more lawsuits and local ban attacks. Now, Indonesia is adopting kratom export regulations that likely will have unnecessary negative impacts on US consumers.

The AKA team isn't spooked though. We're committed to push back on all fronts with your support, and have some big announcements of our own. [So join us this upcoming Wednesday September 18th at 8:30pm ET for an Advocacy Webinar and some exciting announcements.](#)

Be sure to share the link with others and make time to participate Wednesday evening.

Register to Join Webinar
